

Math 241, F04
Quiz 3

Name:
SSN: xxx-xx-

Instructions: There are totally 2 problems. You must show all of your work to receive a credit for a correct answer. No graphical calculator is allowed in the quiz and exam.

Problem 1. (10 points) Let $\mathbf{a} = \langle 3, 3, 1 \rangle$, $\mathbf{b} = \langle -2, -1, 1 \rangle$ and $\mathbf{c} = \langle -4, -3, -1 \rangle$, find each of the following:

a) $\mathbf{a} \times \mathbf{b}$

Solution:

$$\begin{aligned}\mathbf{a} \times \mathbf{b} &= \begin{vmatrix} \mathbf{i} & \mathbf{j} & \mathbf{k} \\ 3 & 3 & 1 \\ -2 & -1 & 1 \end{vmatrix} \\ &= \begin{vmatrix} 3 & 1 \\ -1 & 1 \end{vmatrix} \mathbf{i} - \begin{vmatrix} 3 & 1 \\ -2 & 1 \end{vmatrix} \mathbf{j} + \begin{vmatrix} 3 & 3 \\ -2 & -1 \end{vmatrix} \mathbf{k} \\ &= 4\mathbf{i} - 5\mathbf{j} + 3\mathbf{k}\end{aligned}$$

b) $\mathbf{a} \times (\mathbf{b} \times \mathbf{c})$

Solution: Since

$$\mathbf{a} \cdot \mathbf{b} = \langle 3, 3, 1 \rangle \cdot \langle -2, -1, 1 \rangle = -8$$

$$\mathbf{a} \cdot \mathbf{c} = \langle 3, 3, 1 \rangle \cdot \langle -4, -3, -1 \rangle = -22$$

We have

$$\begin{aligned}\mathbf{a} \times (\mathbf{b} \times \mathbf{c}) &= (\mathbf{a} \cdot \mathbf{c})\mathbf{b} - (\mathbf{a} \cdot \mathbf{b})\mathbf{c} \\ &= -22 \langle -2, -1, 1 \rangle - (-8) \langle -4, -3, -1 \rangle \\ &= \langle 44, 22, -22 \rangle - \langle 32, 24, 8 \rangle \\ &= \langle 12, -2, -30 \rangle\end{aligned}$$

Problem 2. (10 points) Find the symmetric equations of the line of intersection of the given pair of planes:

$$x - 3y + z = -1, \quad 6x - 5y + 4z = 9.$$

Solution: Since $\mathbf{u} = \langle 1, -3, 1 \rangle$ is the normal to the first plane and $\mathbf{v} = \langle 6, -5, 4 \rangle$ is the normal to the second plane, we know a vector parallel to the line of intersection can be given by:

$$\mathbf{w} = \mathbf{u} \times \mathbf{v} = \begin{vmatrix} \mathbf{i} & \mathbf{j} & \mathbf{k} \\ 1 & -3 & 1 \\ 6 & -5 & 4 \end{vmatrix} = -7\mathbf{i} + 2\mathbf{j} + 13\mathbf{k}$$

Then we need to find a point in the line. Let $x = 0$, we have

$$-3y + z = -1$$

$$-5y + 4z = 9$$

By solving it we get $y = 13/7, z = 32/7$, so we know $(0, 13/7, 32/7)$ is in the line.

The symmetric equations are then given by

$$\frac{x}{-7} = \frac{y - 13/7}{2} = \frac{z - 32/7}{13}$$